01 / FOUNDATION

Document control and operating scope

An intentionally synthetic operating manual for evaluating retrieval-augmented generation systems.

1.1 Purpose and applicability

Harborline Fulfillment is a fictional third-party logistics provider used exclusively for testing. This handbook describes its domestic Polish parcel and chilled-grocery fulfillment service. The facts, staff, customer accounts, metrics and prices in this document are invented; they are not instructions for a real company.

This handbook applies to orders accepted through Harborline systems for the WRO-1 and POZ-2 sites. It does not cover cross-border shipping, pharmaceuticals, dangerous goods or consumer-facing retail returns. All clock times use the Europe/Warsaw time zone, and a business day means Monday through Friday excluding Polish public holidays.

1.2 Document identity

Field	Value
Document ID	HF-OPS-2026-Q4
Version	2.4
Effective date	1 October 2026
Owner	Operations Excellence
Classification	Synthetic benchmark / public test data

Version 2.4 supersedes version 2.3. When a Q3 performance result seems different from a Q4 service target, treat the result as a historical observation, not as a revised target. Page 10 lists the Q4 policy changes. Page 9 contains the July-September historical performance records.

1.3 Terminology

An accepted order has passed data validation and entered the warehouse queue. A dispatched shipment has received the first carrier acceptance scan; printing a label or moving a parcel to a staging shelf is not dispatch. A tote is a numbered transport container that may contain more than one chilled-grocery order. A temperature alert is not automatically the same as a quality hold.

BENCHMARK NOTE

Questions may require combining details across pages. Do not assume that a historical result overrides the policy in force on 1 October 2026.

02 / SERVICE CATALOG

Service tiers and dispatch commitments

Order acceptance cutoffs and targets for domestic shipping.

2.1 Published service levels

Tier	Order cutoff	Dispatch target	Delivery expectation
Standard	16:00 Mon-Fri	22:00 same business day	Within 2 business days after dispatch
Express	14:00 Mon-Fri	18:00 same business day	Next business day after dispatch
Chilled Grocery	12:00 Mon-Thu	16:00 same business day	Next business day after dispatch

These dispatch targets apply only to accepted orders received no later than the listed cutoff. An order that arrives after the cutoff joins the next eligible business-day processing cycle. For example, a Standard order accepted at 16:15 on Tuesday is due for dispatch by 22:00 on Wednesday, provided Wednesday is a business day.

2.2 Weekend and holiday handling

Standard and Express orders received on Saturday, Sunday or a Polish public holiday enter the queue for the next business day. Chilled Grocery orders are normally accepted for dispatch Monday through Thursday only. Chilled Grocery orders placed on Friday are held for Monday dispatch unless the Quality Lead has approved an exceptional Friday route in advance.

If a public holiday falls on Monday, a Friday chilled order is held until Tuesday. The promise to deliver on the next business day begins only after the carrier acceptance scan, not after customer checkout.

2.3 Exception ownership

The Operations Manager may authorize additional warehouse staffing but cannot retroactively change an order cutoff, invent a carrier scan or waive a quality hold. Requests to operate an exceptional Friday chilled route must reach the Quality Lead before 10:00 Friday and include a route temperature-monitoring plan.

Dispatch time and delivery time are distinct measurements. An Express shipment dispatched on time can still be delivered late by the carrier; the two events are tracked separately for billing and service-credit purposes.

IMPORTANT DISTINCTION

An accepted order is not yet a dispatched shipment. Calculate on-time dispatch using the first carrier acceptance scan.

03 / INVENTORY

Inbound receiving and storage controls

Scan controls, variance rules and environmental limits.

3.1 Warehouse specialization

WRO-1 (Wroclaw) handles all chilled grocery stock and a limited ambient overflow zone. POZ-2 (Poznan) handles the primary ambient catalog and returns inspection. A chilled order may be picked only at WRO-1; POZ-2 does not hold chilled inventory.

3.2 Receiving and stock variance

Inbound pallets must receive their first dock scan within four hours of their recorded arrival. Each stock keeping unit (SKU) is reconciled against its expected quantity. Escalate a variance to Inventory Control when the absolute difference is greater than three units OR greater than 2% of expected quantity. Exactly three missing units do not trigger the unit threshold, but can still trigger the percentage threshold.

For example, receiving 97 units against 100 expected creates a three-unit, 3% shortage and therefore requires escalation. Receiving 197 against 200 expected creates a three-unit, 1.5% shortage and does not cross either escalation threshold. Negative and positive variances follow the same rule.

3.3 Chilled conditions and sensor policies

The chilled-grocery storage target is 2-6 degrees Celsius. A temperature alert is raised when a monitored location is above 6 degrees Celsius for more than 10 consecutive minutes. A quality hold is mandatory when the measured temperature is above 8 degrees Celsius for more than 5 consecutive minutes. The quality hold remains active until a documented release decision is recorded by the Quality Lead.

Stationary cold-room sensors are reviewed twice per operating day. Their formal calibration cycle is annual, with the next documented calibration due on 15 January 2027. A missed calibration is a quality-system finding and must be escalated even when temperature readings appear plausible.

THRESHOLD LOGIC

“More than” is strict. Exactly 10 minutes above 6 C is not sufficient for an alert; exactly 5 minutes above 8 C is not sufficient for the mandatory hold.

04 / WAREHOUSE EXECUTION

Picking, packing and traceability

How accepted orders become verified parcels.

4.1 Four-stage handling sequence

1. Release. The order is validated, assigned to a site and released into a pick wave.
2. Pick. Operators scan each item barcode and the matching order line; mismatches block completion.
3. Pack. Operators check protection materials, attach a traceable seal ID and record parcel weight.
4. Handover. Parcels are loaded into the carrier cage; dispatch occurs only when the carrier records its acceptance scan.

4.2 Independent second checks

An independent second check is required for any order with merchandise value of at least PLN 500, regardless of service tier. The same check is required for any Chilled Grocery order containing four or more individual units, even if its value is below PLN 500. Meeting either rule is enough; both rules need not apply.

The second checker compares the order line count, SKU barcodes, seal ID and listed parcel weight before authorizing handover. The original picker cannot act as the independent checker for their own order. If the check fails, the package returns to the picking station for correction.

4.3 Quality measurements

The packaging-compliance target is at least 99.5% of audited parcels per month. The mispick-rate ceiling is 0.25% of shipped order lines per month. These are operational quality indicators; they are not identical to the historical pick-accuracy figures presented on page 9.

Each parcel record stores the accepted-order timestamp, SKU scan results, picker identifier, optional second-check identifier, seal ID, carrier and first carrier acceptance timestamp. The tracking label alone never proves handover.

TRACEABILITY RULE

A second check is needed for PLN 500 or more, OR for four or more chilled units. It is not a discretionary risk flag.

05 / CARRIER NETWORK

Carrier transport and telemetry

Routing, sensor uploads and monitoring gaps.

5.1 Assigned carriers

SwiftRoute is Harborline’s default domestic carrier for Standard and Express parcels. PolarFleet is the designated carrier for Chilled Grocery shipments. An exception to the chilled carrier assignment requires documented approval from the Quality Lead before handover.

5.2 Chilled transport monitoring

A chilled tote includes an electronic temperature sensor and a reusable insulated container. The sensor samples temperature every five minutes and uploads its cached readings every 15 minutes when connected. The transport monitoring team reviews trends at route start, at the midpoint and after the final stop.

A telemetry upload gap longer than 30 minutes creates a data-gap flag for investigation. A gap longer than 60 minutes requires manual quality assessment before the related tote can be closed as compliant. A data gap alone does not prove a temperature excursion or require automatic disposal of the goods.

If a live chilled-tote reading remains above 8 degrees Celsius for more than five consecutive minutes, a quality hold must be opened under the same hold rule as page 3. The carrier is instructed not to release affected goods until the Quality Lead decides whether release is justified.

5.3 Delay classifications

A carrier delivery delay begins after dispatch and is recorded using proof-of-delivery events. A warehouse dispatch miss is measured before the first carrier acceptance scan. Service credits on page 8 use the dispatch miss, not a carrier-delivery delay, as their standard trigger.

Whenever a transport issue spans more than one tote, the incident owner records all affected tote IDs and shipment IDs. If the severity thresholds on page 6 are met, the transport event must also be logged as a formal incident.

TELEMETRY RULE

>30 minutes: flag and investigate. >60 minutes: manual quality assessment. Neither threshold automatically means the goods were spoiled.

06 / INCIDENT MANAGEMENT

Incident severity and response

Clear escalation deadlines and evidence requirements.

6.1 Classification and timers

Severity	Illustrative trigger	Acknowledge	Escalate	Initial report
SEV1	Mandatory hold affecting >10 totes	15 minutes	60 minutes	Within 4 hours
SEV2	Delivery disruption affecting >30 orders	1 hour	4 hours	1 business day
SEV3	Single-parcel cosmetic packaging issue	1 business day	No fixed deadline	Weekly summary

The clock starts when the incident is created in the incident register, not when a manager first reads a message. The illustrative triggers in the table do not rule out other causes of equivalent impact; the Quality Lead makes the final determination when chilled-product integrity is at risk.

6.2 Response sequence

The on-call operator logs the incident ID, affected shipment IDs, first observed event time, description, owner, available evidence and provisional severity. The responder must acknowledge within the applicable timer. Any severity change is time-stamped; upgrades take effect immediately, while previous response breaches remain visible in the audit log.

For SEV1, the Operations Manager coordinates the site response, and the Quality Lead decides the product disposition. The first report within four hours summarizes scope, known facts, evidence gaps and containment status. It is not required to establish the root cause within four hours.

6.3 Closure requirements

An incident may be closed only after containment, impact analysis, assigned corrective action and responsible owner have been recorded. A missing sensor upload is not evidence that temperature remained within range. If telemetry is incomplete, the final report must state that limitation explicitly.

Severity rules are intentionally strict: exactly ten affected totes does not satisfy the “more than ten totes” SEV1 example, and exactly 30 impacted orders does not satisfy the “more than 30 orders” SEV2 example.

TIME BASIS

Acknowledge, escalation and initial-report deadlines are three different obligations. Do not substitute one for another.

07 / CUSTOMER OPERATIONS

Customer claims and returns workflow

Deadlines, evidence and return authorization.

7.1 Claim submission

Clients must report a missing-item or visible-damage claim within three business days after delivery. A valid claim includes the shipment ID, the affected SKU, a short description of the problem and supporting photographs for visible damage. For missing items, the client provides the packing list and the quantity received; photographs are requested only when helpful.

Claims submitted after the three-business-day window may still be reviewed as goodwill cases, but are not automatically eligible under the standard claim process. Customer Operations logs each case under a unique CLM identifier and prevents two refunds for the same affected order line.

7.2 Return authorization and timing

After reviewing evidence, Customer Operations must issue an approval or rejection decision on a return merchandise authorization (RMA) request within two business days. If approved, the client has 14 calendar days from the approval date to send the product back. POZ-2 inspects received ambient returns within two business days of arrival.

Unsolicited returned goods without an RMA are not added to sellable stock. They are physically segregated while Customer Operations identifies the sender and decides the next step. Chilled products are not returned into sellable inventory through the ambient POZ-2 process.

7.3 Financial resolution

Once a claim or return refund is formally approved, Finance issues the refund or credit note within five business days. The refund timer begins at financial approval, not at original delivery and not when a client creates the initial complaint.

A customer claim is distinct from a contractual dispatch service credit. Claims address missing or damaged merchandise; the service credit on page 8 addresses eligible missed dispatch commitments. They follow different submission windows.

TWO WINDOWS

Claims: within 3 business days after delivery. Approved returns: send back within 14 calendar days after RMA approval.

08 / BILLING

Commercial charges and service credits

Fees, eligibility exclusions and monthly limits.

8.1 Published handling prices

Billable item	Published price	Unit
Standard fulfillment	PLN 8.40	Per dispatched parcel
Express fulfillment	PLN 14.20	Per dispatched parcel
Chilled Grocery fulfillment	PLN 19.50	Per dispatched parcel
Ambient storage	PLN 0.06	Per unit per calendar day

Ambient storage has a minimum monthly charge of PLN 80 per client account. The minimum applies to the storage line item only; it is not a minimum for parcel fulfillment. Published prices exclude any taxes. A single order can create more than one parcel, but the fulfillment fee is always assessed per dispatched parcel.

8.2 When a service credit applies

A client may request a credit when Harborline misses the published dispatch deadline for an eligible, on-time accepted order. The standard credit is 20% of the fulfillment fee for the affected parcel; it is not 20% of the merchandise value or the entire invoice. Total service credits for one client are capped at PLN 300 per calendar month.

No standard dispatch credit is payable for an order received after the published cutoff, a customer-address validation failure or a documented force-majeure interruption. A late carrier delivery after an on-time dispatch is not itself a standard credit trigger. Contract-specific remedies outside this handbook are not part of this benchmark.

8.3 Submission deadline and arithmetic

Clients must submit service-credit requests within ten business days after the end of the service month. Finance validates accepted timestamps, carrier scans, exclusions and the monthly cap. For one eligible late Express parcel, the standard 20% credit is PLN 2.84 (20% of PLN 14.20), subject to the client monthly cap.

CALCULATION EXAMPLE

Ten Express parcels plus five Chilled Grocery parcels cost PLN 239.50 in fulfillment fees, before storage and taxes.

09 / PERFORMANCE

Historical performance - Q3 2026

Observed monthly results; these are not future guarantees.

9.1 Monthly operations dashboard

Indicator	July	August	September
Accepted orders	18,400	19,250	21,000
On-time dispatch	98.6%	99.1%	99.4%
Pick accuracy	99.62%	99.70%	99.78%
Chilled temperature alerts	14	9	6
Telemetry gaps >30 minutes	4	3	1

On-time dispatch means the percentage of eligible, on-time accepted orders dispatched by the service-tier deadline. Pick accuracy is measured on completed picked lines. Temperature alerts count monitoring events, not necessarily spoiled products. Telemetry gaps count upload interruptions longer than 30 minutes.

9.2 How to interpret the table

The Q4 target for on-time dispatch is at least 99.2% per calendar month across the service tiers. September 2026 (99.4%) would meet that target if judged against it, whereas August (99.1%) and July (98.6%) would not. The Q4 operational threshold for chilled temperature alerts is no more than eight per month; only September meets that threshold among these three months.

Between July and September, pick accuracy rose from 99.62% to 99.78%, an increase of 0.16 percentage points. Chilled temperature alerts fell from 14 to 6, a reduction of eight events. Do not report the 0.16-point increase as a 0.16% relative improvement.

9.3 Improvement activity and interpretation

A double-scan picking pilot started at WRO-1 on 15 August 2026. A related pilot started at POZ-2 on 30 September 2026. The dashboard does not isolate the effect of either pilot; improved figures cannot be attributed causally to the pilots using these numbers alone.

Harborline reviews this dashboard on the first Wednesday after each month closes. Reported figures are locked after the Finance reconciliation stage, but corrections can be appended with an audit trail and an explicit restatement note.

HISTORICAL VS TARGET

99.4% is the September result. 99.2% is the Q4 monthly dispatch target. They represent different concepts.

10 / GOVERNANCE

Q4 change control, roles and retention

Policy authority and reference rules for unusual cases.

10.1 Effective changes on 1 October 2026

The Standard order cutoff changed from 15:00 in version 2.3 to 16:00 in version 2.4. The Express cutoff remains 14:00 and the Chilled Grocery cutoff remains 12:00 Monday through Thursday. The Friday chilled-order default remains a hold for Monday dispatch except for a Quality-Lead-approved exceptional route.

This release also standardizes the temperature rules across the cold room and transport network: alert above 6 degrees Celsius for more than 10 consecutive minutes; mandatory quality hold above 8 degrees Celsius for more than 5 consecutive minutes. An alert by itself does not force a hold.

10.2 Decision rights

Role	Named owner	Authorized decision
Operations Manager	Mara Ellis	Staffing and dispatch recovery
Quality Lead	Lena Ortiz	Chilled route exception and release of a quality hold
Finance Owner	Theo Park	Credit and refund authorization
Data Operations Lead	Nika Rao	Telemetry integrity and dashboard corrections

Only the Quality Lead can approve release from a mandatory chilled-goods quality hold after reviewing temperature records and supporting evidence. Operations staff and carrier managers cannot self-release affected product. The Data Operations Lead can correct a sensor record but cannot authorize the physical release of chilled goods.

10.3 Record retention and document precedence

Temperature telemetry is retained for 180 days after collection. Formal claim case files are retained for 24 months after closure. If a site poster or an archived email contradicts version 2.4 of this handbook, version 2.4 takes precedence for events on or after 1 October 2026; historical events are judged by the version in force on their event date.

The Operations Excellence team reviews policy exceptions at a Tuesday 10:00 Europe/Warsaw meeting. Meeting discussions do not change this handbook until a new controlled version has been approved and published.

SOURCE OF TRUTH

Use the effective-date rule when comparing a historical number with a current policy. The CEO name and international shipping tariffs are deliberately absent from this document.